

Great news!

Physics says cell phones can't cause cancer
<http://goo.gl/kv2N>

Angry birds flying

Android users can now download the full version of the popular Angry Birds game from getjar.com or the Market

Consumer protection

Know your rights

Warranty cards

Another mistake we're almost always culpable of is worrying about the price, and not the documentation. Make sure to get those warranty documents stamped and filled out.

Although most of us don't really care about this, and most big brands will still honour their warranty just by looking at your bill, don't assume that this will always be the case. By law, if the warranty card is not filled out properly by the dealer, the brand has the right to refuse you service. If you don't believe us, read the fine print on the warranty card.

Why take chances with expensive purchases, when it will only waste a few minutes of your time to get the dealer to fill it out?

MRP

The maximum retail price (MRP) of a product is binding by law. You have the right to lodge a complaint with the Weights and

Measurement Department, or with a consumer court, if anyone sells you a product for more than the MRP. Remember to get the bill of course, so that you can prove it.

In all honesty, if someone tries and sells you something at MRP in the tech field, just walk away – almost every gadget we've ever come across is sold lower than MRP. It has been known to happen though, and vendors claim that this is because of a price rise – however, by law, all old stock has to be sold at the old prices that were in force when the seller purchased it from the distributor.

Precautions

It is also the duty of the manufacturing company to clearly inform you about specific details of a product. For example, if a mixer-grinder should not be run continuously for more than a specific time, then it is the duty of the company to warn you of that through the documentation provided.

Warranty cards

Finally, if for some reason, despite all the precautions you take, you find yourself being denied your rights, you should file a complaint in consumer court. You can even argue your own case, since a lawyer is not mandatory. You need to make sure that you have filed a formal complaint with the manufacturer before approaching the courts, though, in order to give the manufacturer the opportunity to address your grievances. In fact, it is often beneficial to your case if you've made formal complaints and sent notices to the manufacturer, which might tilt the court's decision in your favour.

Another advantage of issuing these notices is that the matter is often escalated within the company, and you might find your problem gets resolved quicker.

At the end of the day, all that matters is that you have peace of mind, and are not cheated out of your hard-earned money. 

COMPLAINTS RECEIVED

Mobile Phones

Case File #983

Coolpad mobiles are not providing essential accessories like charger

Coolpad mobiles are not providing essential accessories like charger. I have purchased a Coolpad 2938 mobile phone from Reliance store in Hiranandani. The charger of the phone started malfunctioning and I am not able to get the new charger of this phone in open market. The Reliance store directed me to go to Coolpad service center. But their response is very bad despite writing to their head office in Chennai.

I am unable to use the phone and want to make a legal complaint against this dealer and manufacturer.

Zubair Ahmed Khan Sarguroh

Answer by Consumermate:

Dear Customer,
It is duty of the company to provide you

the essential accessories of the product without which proper functioning of the products are not possible. You are right in saying that you can file a consumer complaint with consumer court for the same. Before doing that write a letter to them in shape of a legal demand notice to arrange a charger for you within two weeks time failing which you can go ahead with your complaint. I hope some sense will prevail over them and they will arrange charger for you.

Laptops

Case File #1009

Not getting the delivery of Laptop

I have booked a laptop and made 100% payment on 27.07.10. My Order No is 840079839. My Quotation number is 24019051 and customer reference number is 781878697. The dealer through whom I have booked the laptop is not responding to me. I have asked them to mail me final date of delivery

but still it is not committed by the sales person nor any customer care executive. Now I am worried whether I will get the laptop or not.

Sona Kelshiker

Answer by Consumermate:

Dear Consumer,
Thanks for sharing your grievances with us. But you have not made clear that from where have booked the product. It's not a new case that a company backing out once the product is sold and consideration received. Anyways, you can address a registered letter to the company calling upon them to deliver the product within two weeks. In this case, you should file a complaint before the consumer forum and before the police as well as it may be case of fraud subject to facts of your case. I hope this would be sufficient for the purpose they will deliver the product if they would be sensible enough.